

Guardrailed site assistant

A generic website chatbot becomes a scoped intake assistant that answers within guardrails and escalates only qualified consultation leads to a human.

CLIENT ABBADev Tech Solutions (this site)	SECTOR Professional services / lead gen	DURATION One focused increment	STACK React/Vite · Node · n8n · Postgres · Telegram
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01 / PROBLEM

- One high-commitment CTA (the full consultation form) and no low-friction way to ask a scoped question or self-qualify first.
- A generic AI chatbot would risk off-topic or fabricated answers, contradicting the site's "AI with guardrails" thesis.
- Lead capture had to reach the founder reliably without burying real prospects under every casual question.

02 / APPROACH

- Answer scoped questions client-side from a curated knowledge base via deterministic intent matching — no free-text model call.
- Make the assistant itself the proof: AI-guided intake, deterministic rules, a human owner confirming the path.
- Escalate only a completed brief — a workflow challenge plus a validated email — not every conversation.
- Keep the chat lead pipeline separate from the website form, with its own webhook and secret.

03 / IMPLEMENTATION

01 Guardrailed knowledge base

Curated intent matching answers services, proof, pricing, and process questions in the browser — no free-text model call.

02 Guided consult flow

A two-question brief (workflow challenge, then a validated email) prepares a qualified lead inside the chat.

03 Isolated lead pipeline

A Node proxy validates the email, stamps the channel server-side, and forwards to a dedicated n8n webhook with its own secret.

04 Store and notify

n8n normalizes the lead, writes it to a Postgres table, and alerts the founder on Telegram in real time.

04 / RESULTS

Assistant answers Before: Open-ended AI After » Guardrailed KB Deterministic intent matching keeps replies scoped to real services.	Escalation to a human Before: Every visitor After » Qualified leads Only a completed Book-a-consult brief reaches a person.	Lead pipeline Before: Shared secret After » Dedicated token Chat leads use their own n8n webhook and secret.
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“The assistant is the argument. It answers within guardrails and only escalates a real lead to a person — the same AI-with-ownership model we build for clients.”

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